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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 51966.03 ▼ 36.38 0.07% NASDAQ 26430.89 ▲ 1.1% STOXX 600 639.56 ▼ 0.8% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 9/32, yield 5.135% OIL $103.66 ▲ $2.25 GOLD $4,139.00 ▼ $20.50 EURO $1.1213 YEN 158.52

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Wall Street and viewers** will be looking for answers to their questions when Netflix reports its third-quarter earnings on Tuesday. **A1**

◆ **U.S. stocks ended** mixed, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq rising 0.4% and 1.1%, respectively, and the Dow falling by less than 0.1%. **B10**

◆ **Elon Musk said** he would give every child in the U.S. one SpaceX share, following pledges by other high-profile billionaires to donate some of their wealth. **B1**

◆ **The Saudi national** accused of bugging an OpenAI conference room had earlier been in touch with a Saudi royal about job opportunities in the kingdom, prosecutors said. **B1**

◆ **Nvidia-backed** startup doubleAI said it was set to unveil what it called a new category of artificial intelligence that can help companies lower their computing costs. **B1**

◆ **Lindt replaced** Chief Executive Officer Adalbert Lechner with Dieter Weisskopf, the company's former boss, as the chocolatier tries to revive growth. **B2**

◆ **JPMorgan Chase** said it has financed $230 billion of projects through its $1.5 trillion national-security initiative that it announced last year. **B1**

◆ **Roche entered** into a collaboration and licensing agreement with Hansoh Pharmaceutical that could net the Chinese drugmaker more than $15 billion. **B6**

◆ **KKR agreed to sell** Infinity to Ares Management for about $2.9 billion after owning the railcar-leasing company for roughly five years and helping it more than double its book value. **B10**

Worldwide

◆ **Saudi Arabia postponed** its flagship investor conference following missile attacks on the kingdom's airports and capital city by Iran-backed Houthi militants in Yemen. **A1**

◆ **The riots sweeping** France handed Marine Le Pen on the political right the opportunity to present herself as a leader in waiting and the sole candidate in next year's presidential election willing to restore order. **A1, A8**

◆ **Trump said he would** be open to meeting the leaders of Russia and China to discuss denuclearization, a comment that came after Putin proposed that the three men meet to discuss Ukraine. **A7**

◆ **The Department of** Homeland Security ordered federal civilian agencies to remove artificial-intelligence technology developed by China's DeepSeek from their IT systems. **A2**

◆ **Vice President JD Vance** declined to back Netanyahu in Israel's coming elections, in a break from Trump. **A10**

◆ **Israeli police said** they arrested 10 people in connection with settler violence in the occupied West Bank. **A10**

◆ **Hedge-fund billionaires** Steve and Sue Mandel have poured at least $20 million into political, policy and media projects that are challenging the Democratic establishment. **A6**

◆ **The campaign of** Republican David Flippo, who is running for a House seat in Nevada, credited a dead woman for a donation. **A4**

◆ **The Tampa Bay Rays** won the American League championship and will face the Milwaukee Brewers in baseball's World Series.

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OLIVIER CHASSIGNOLE/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A city employee cleans graffiti from a fountain in Lyon on Monday after nationwide protests in France devolved into riots.

Le Pen Seizes on Chaos in France To Bolster Her Presidential Bid

By Stacy Meichtry

PARIS—The riots sweeping France have rocked the country's political establishment, but one person is positioned to emerge from the chaos with a strengthened hand: Marine Le Pen.

For more than a decade the far-right leader has cast France as a nation adrift, buffeted by waves of immigration and lawlessness that have torn at the country's social fabric. As bands of hooded rioters in dark clothing have descended on city centers across France, raiding city halls and looting thousands of stores, Le Pen has sought to present herself as the sole candidate in next spring's presidential election willing to restore order.

The strategy was on display this week as Le Pen released a video address that bore the hallmarks of a president addressing the nation. Seated at a desk before an august bookcase and flanked by France's tricolor flag, Le Pen cast the riots as a crisis of faith in President Emmanuel Macron's authority.

"Our country is caught in a vice, held hostage between violence and powerlessness," Le Pen said. "In six months, the French people will be able to choose a different path—one of authority and restored security."

The approach has given Le Pen an air of inevitability in her pursuit of France's highest office.

"It's as if she's at the office, already at the Élysée Palace," said Adélaïde Zulfikarpasic, a pollster at the French polling firm Ipsos Bva.

Le Pen's long-running focus on law and order, Zulfikarpasic said, allows her to act as a guarantor of stability at a time when democracy itself is in crisis.

"People no longer have confidence in the state to ensure their protection and meet their needs. And she's contrasting with that," she said.

The riots are working to Le Pen's advantage in other ways. As the violence has flared, Jean-Luc Mélenchon, the far-left firebrand running for

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◆ **Police in Paris impose a curfew..... A8**

'Davos In Desert' Delayed By Houthi Airstrikes

Missile attacks prompt Saudis to postpone investment event until 2027

DUBAI—Saudi Arabia has decided to postpone its flagship investor conference, highlighting how missile attacks on the kingdom's airports and capital city by the Iran-backed Houthi militants in Yemen are threatening its economic ambitions.

*By **Stephen Kalin**, **Georgi Kantchev** and **Saleh al-Batati***

Saudi Arabia's Future Investment Initiative, a marquee showcase for foreign investment, was to gather the global financial elite in Riyadh beginning Oct. 26. Organizers decided earlier Monday that the conference wouldn't be held in person, then later told attendees it would be postponed until next year.

The escalating conflict with the Houthis is compounding the challenges facing Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman's push to attract foreign investment and spur growth as mounting war costs strain the kingdom's already stressed finances.

Billed as "Davos in the Desert," the annual FII gathering had become a centerpiece of his Vision 2030 agenda to turn the oil exporter into an international hub for business and tourism.

Wall Street executives were already reconsidering whether to travel to the conference, weighing security concerns against the risk of offending their wealthy hosts. Some bankers at JPMorgan Chase and Citigroup were canceling meetings, while personnel

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Netflix Shake-Up Follows Struggles

Netflix is writing a new script.

It abruptly replaced content chief Bela Bajaria last week just hours after a layoff of 1,000 employees that she helped engineer. By Monday, film chief Dan Lin had lost his job, too.

*By **Ben Fritz**, **Jessica Toonkel** and **Joe Flint***

The ousters of two of the company's top creative executives are a sign that the streaming giant's leaders feel the service needs a creative overhaul.

Co-Chief Executive Ted Sarandos had complained internally for months that people in the U.S. were spending less time watching Netflix and that the service was short on new hit shows, people familiar with the matter said. He has also told colleagues that he wants the company, which has experimented with everything from videogames to podcasts, to strengthen its core TV and movie offerings.

On Tuesday, the company is set to deliver its third-quarter earnings and try to answer Wall Street's questions about its strategy.

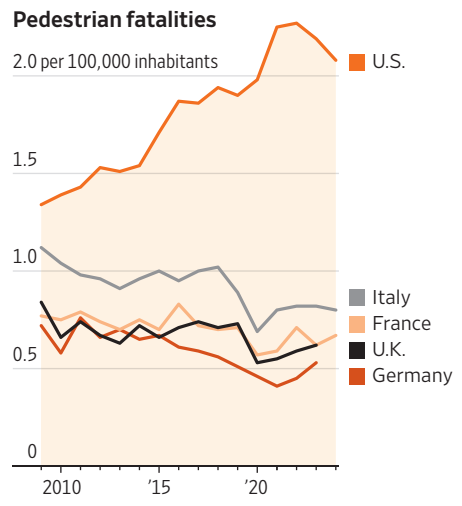
Problems at the company that ushered in Hollywood's streaming revolution have been building for a year as it has struggled to come up with hits on the level of "Stranger Things" or "Squid Game."

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Netflix stock might be a hit..... B11**

Road Design's Fatal Flaw

U.S. roads are becoming deadlier for pedestrians. Increasingly, people are hit by cars on roads designed like Union Avenue in Memphis, Tenn.—all while this type of roadway continues to spread across the country. **A3**



Note: 2024 data unavailable for Germany and the U.K.
Sources: Department of Transportation (U.S. fatalities); UNECE (other fatalities, 2005-2023); OECD (other fatalities, 2024); World Bank (population)

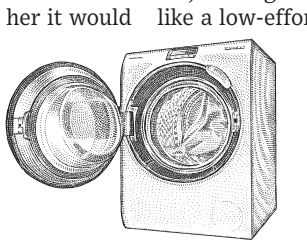
The Internet Sold Them the Lie That Laundromats Are Easy Money

* * *

Sure the quarters are flowing in. But watch out for the dog hairs and the drug dealers.

By John Keilman

Three years ago, Atusa Parsa bought a laundromat in Fullerton, Calif., after social media convinced her it would be a great investment. She quickly learned there were many things the content didn't cover—like how to evict the drug dealers in the bathroom.



Spin cycle

"No matter how easy they make it look, the process is a little more involved," said Parsa, who cleaned out her establishment with the help of police.

The once-humble laundromat has become a social-media supernova in recent years. Videos linger over the mounds of quarters and stacks of bills a store's machines can generate, making the business look like a low-effort, high-reward way to pursue the American dream.

This vision of passive income has found a ready audience in an age of economic anxiety, when the traditional career ladder appears to be broken and the AI revolution looms. But Brian Wallace, chief executive of the Coin Laundry Association, said some influencers aren't giving the full picture.

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Billionaire Battles Two Fierce Foes: Wife and Partner

Hedge-fund feud spills into divorce trial

By Peter Rudegeair

Hedge-fund billionaire John Overdeck is going through two acrimonious breakups at once.

One is a tabloid-worthy court battle with his estranged wife over whether the $723 million he has offered her is fair settlement for the dissolution of their nearly 24-year marriage. The other is a longer running and possibly nastier standoff with his co-founder at Two Sigma—an $85 billion quant-trading colossus—over the direction and control of the firm.

Sitting in the witness box in a New Jersey family court on Aug. 19, with his wife Laura watching him from a few yards away, Overdeck was trying to prevent the first battle from costing him the second.

Laura Overdeck's lawyers

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China's Export Boom Masks Woes at Home

By Hannah Miao

BEIJING—Vivian Wei is shutting her business. After more than a decade as a headhunter, work has dried up. The big Chinese tech companies that once paid Wei to recruit engineers by the hundreds have been laying off employees instead.

Wei, 46 years old, estimated that her income has more than halved in the past few years. Lately, she and her husband have cut down on nonessential spending to save money. She used to splurge on skin-care products, but switched to a cheaper domestic brand.

Some of her neighbors lost their jobs and have become drivers for DiDi, China's main ride-hailing platform. Wei's biggest concern now is whether her 12-year-old son will be able to get a job when he grows up.

"I don't know what the future holds," Wei said.

For people across China, economic worries are mounting. A multiyear real-estate slump has no end in sight, steady jobs are becoming rarer, especially for young people, and many people seem to be hoarding their money in preparation for worse times ahead.

That means China has to look abroad for economic growth, which is in turn raising tensions with trading

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